Assessment of English Language Proficiency Procedure

1. Purpose

To establish a consistent, course-specific and auditable process for assessing the English language proficiency of overseas students applying to TIIS CRICOS-registered courses delivered in Australia. This Procedure implements the TIIS Admission Policy and addresses risks identified in the September 2026 English Entry Benchmark Report, including test equivalencies, productive skills, alternative evidence and student outcomes.

2. Scope and Regulatory Application

This Procedure applies only to applicants for, and overseas students enrolled in, TIIS CRICOS-registered courses at approved Australian delivery locations, and to Admissions, the Registrar, Academic Dean, Course Coordinators, authorised assessors, Quality & Compliance and recruitment personnel involved in their assessment. It does not apply to domestic applicants or wholly offshore/TNE students.

Applicants must meet approved course-specific TIIS English entry requirements. Academic admission standards and Department of Home Affairs student visa English requirements are distinct; applicable obligations under the ESOS Act 2000 and National Code 2018 must also be observed. TIIS assesses academic eligibility; Home Affairs determines visa eligibility.

3. Authority, Hierarchy and Approval Status

- Applicable legislation and binding course accreditation or CRICOS registration conditions.
- Academic Board-approved admission standards and TIIS Admission Policy and Procedure.
- Current formally authorised Course Entry Requirements Register (CERR).
- Supporting benchmarking reports and analyses.

Where requirements conflict, the higher-level authority prevails. The CERR records approved requirements but does not independently authorise changes. Benchmarking recommendations remain advisory until formally approved.

4. Existing English Language Entry Requirements

The following IELTS Academic thresholds are the baseline identified in the English Language Entry Requirements Benchmark Report 2026. The formally approved course-specific CERR remains authoritative.

AQF level	Existing IELTS Academic threshold
AQF 7 – Bachelor's Degree	6.0 overall; no individual band below 5.5
AQF 8 – Graduate Certificate/Diploma	6.0 overall; minimum 6.0 in every band
AQF 9 – Coursework Master's Degree	6.5 overall; no individual band below 6.0

5. Test Validity, Integrity and Verification

- Validity: Apply the validity period specified in the approved CERR, subject to any overriding binding requirement. Calculate from the official test date to the applicable admission assessment reference date.

- Accepted tests and formats: Verify current approved TIIS requirements and, separately, applicable Home Affairs rules for accepted test formats and secure test centres.
- Authentication: Independently verify identity, issuing source, test date, test format, overall and component scores, scale and validity through an official channel or reliable method.
- Multiple sittings, one-skill retakes or combined scores may be accepted only where expressly authorised by applicable approved requirements.
- Screenshots, unverifiable agent assertions, outdated concordance tables and unauthorised score combinations are insufficient. Hold admission and escalate suspected fraud or inconsistencies.

Record the verification method and outcome in the student-specific Eligibility Assessment Record (EAR).

6. Alternative Evidence and English Preparation Pathways

Prior English-medium study, Australian AQF qualifications, approved EAP/ELICOS completion or TIIS internal assessments may be accepted only where expressly authorised in the course-specific CERR, with documented conditions, equivalence rationale, verification and approval authority. An alternative pathway must also be assessed against any separately applicable visa requirements.

Completion of a pathway alone does not guarantee admission. The Academic Dean documents each authorised equivalency decision and its basis in the EAR before Registrar clearance. The Registrar maintains controlled pathway and exception records; no officer may waive mandatory standards.

If evidence is insufficient or a pathway is not approved, record Pending or Not Met. Conditional offers may be issued only where the Admission Policy permits; unconditional offers and CoEs must not be issued until all mandatory academic English criteria are Met.

7. Internal English Proficiency Assessment

A TIIS internal assessment may be used only if expressly authorised in the course-specific CERR. Before use, the Academic Dean must approve:

- An assessment blueprint aligned with course language demands, four-skill coverage or an approved documented alternative, and minimum standards.
- Assessor qualifications, identity verification, security, rubrics, moderation and appeal arrangements.
- Record retention and periodic validation against recognised external tests and subsequent student outcomes.

Third-party assessments require equivalent TIIS-approved controls and independent verification. An internal or third-party assessment does not itself establish visa English eligibility.

8. Assessment and Approval Workflow

1. Admissions confirms the CRICOS course, AQF level, intake, approved Australian campus and current CERR version.

2. Admissions collects and independently verifies identity and English evidence, including format, validity, scale and component results.

3. Admissions records the test, scores, date, verification source, assessor and each CERR criterion in the EAR as Met, Not Met, Pending or N/A.

4. Alternative evidence, borderline results and uncertain conversions are referred to the Academic Dean, who determines only authorised equivalencies and records reasons.

5. The Registrar independently reviews the EAR and Dean determinations, verifies that mandatory criteria are Met and records the admission decision.

6. Conditional offers identify outstanding criteria, evidence, deadlines and authority; unconditional offers and CoEs remain blocked while mandatory criteria are Pending or Not Met.

7. Before CoE release, the Registrar separately verifies written agreement, acceptance, fees and required admission checks under the Admission Policy. Applicable visa English requirements are considered separately; Home Affairs determines visa eligibility.

9. Post-Entry Support, Cohort Monitoring and Escalation

Students admitted at minimum thresholds or through approved alternative pathways receive documented orientation and appropriate academic English support. Admissions and Academic Services retain entry tests, overall and component scores (particularly writing), pathways, courses, cohorts and intakes.

At least once per teaching block, the Academic Dean and Registrar review early pass rates, interventions, retention and progression by entry test, band and pathway. Adverse trends trigger investigation, risk assessment and recommendations to the Academic Board. Quality & Compliance undertakes risk-based sampling and monitors corrective-action closure; material risks are escalated.

10. Roles and Accountabilities

Role	Accountability
Academic Board	Approves substantive entry standards and pathways within delegation; reviews performance and changes.
Academic Dean	Oversees standards, validates internal assessments and decides expressly authorised equivalencies.
Registrar	Maintains CERR and exception records; independently reviews EARs; controls admission and CoE clearance.
Admissions	Collects, verifies and records evidence; refers exceptions; cannot waive requirements.
Quality & Compliance	Samples compliance, monitors corrective actions and escalates material risks.
Course Coordinators / Academic Services	Provide support and student-outcome evidence relevant to English readiness.
Recruitment personnel / education agents	Provide approved information and collect evidence; cannot approve entry equivalencies.

11. Records Management and Change Control

Retain English evidence, independent verification records, EARs, authorised decisions, controlled pathway records, conditional-offer clearances, CoE checks and cohort monitoring reports securely under TIIS records and privacy requirements and applicable ESOS record-retention obligations.

12. Review and Version Control

Version	Date	Status	Change summary
1.1	27 Oct 2026	Approval	Scope restricted to CRICOS overseas students studying in

			Australia;